Ervine, Craig ZIM

Zimbabwe M · LHB · Batting profile (ODI)

RUNS	AVERAGE	STRIKE RATE	MEDIAN % OF RUNS	CARRIES THE INNINGS
1680	**28.0**	**73.9**	**8.7%**	**21%**
60 dismissals · 66 inns	3-YR 24.6	3-YR 77.7	of team, per innings 3-YR 14.4%	innings with ≥25% of team 3-YR 18%

SUMMARY

- A solid, steady batter — vulnerable to seam.
- They get out most often to balls that are **full and down the leg side** (4.0 dismissals/100).
- Most often out **caught behind** (32% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19).

COMMON THEMES

- left-hand bat, averaging 28.0 at a strike rate of 73.9.
- Carries a big share of the batting — 13.5% of team runs.
- Scores mainly through the V (39%).

STRENGTHS

- Main scoring shot is the work/nudge (36% of runs).
- The **sweep** brings them 11% of their runs — 1.5× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **pull/hook** (4% of runs vs 14% typically).
- Handles both similarly (pace 25, spin 32).
- Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (2.5 early vs 2.8/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (38%).

WEAKNESSES / HOW TO GET HIM

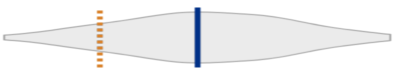
- Most often out **caught behind** (32% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19).
- Vulnerable to the **good length** (averages 20 there vs 28 overall; 2.9 dismissals/100).
- Struggles **in the channel** (20 avg, 2.5 outs/100).
- The ball that seams away hurts them (avg 41 vs 62 when it holds its line).
- Most dangerous ball: **full and down the leg side** (4.0 dismissals/100, avg 18).
- His **pull/hook** is high-risk (false shot 31%, 8.9 outs/100).

Batting Fingerprint (percentile vs Test batters)

A solid, steady batter — vulnerable to seam.

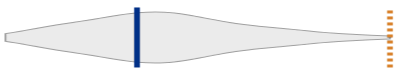
Changing (last 3 years vs career): strike rate up; average down; false % vs pace up.

Average
P47 → **P15**



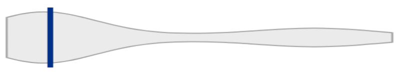
34.8 · higher = better

Strike rate
P39 → **P98**



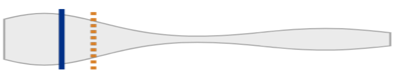
50.0 · higher = better

False-shot %
P41



16.6% · higher = weaker

False % vs pace
P47 → **P60**

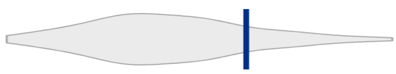


21.1% · higher = weaker

False % vs spin
P47 → **P47**

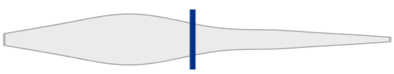
12.8% · higher = weaker

False % vs seam
P84



27.4% · higher = weaker

False % vs swing
P71

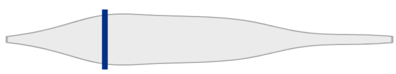


18.4% · higher = weaker

False % vs short
P61

20.2% · higher = weaker

Boundary %
P24



5.5% · higher = better

__Solid line = career__, __dotted = last 3 years__ (avg / SR / false% vs pace & spin). Percentile among Test batters (≥1500 balls). Red = a target (high vulnerability); green = a strength.

Match Impact (share of runs)

Makes 13.5% of their team's runs over a career (typical innings 8.7%), and 6.5% of all runs in their matches; carries the innings (≥25% of the team's runs) 21% of the time, and dominates (≥40%) 8%.

Against Each Bowler Type

Handles both similarly (pace 25, spin 32).

Bowler type	Average	Strike rate	False-shot %	Dismissals / 100	Balls
Pace	25.4	69.4	19.9%	2.73	1,208
Spin	32.1	79.0	12.4%	2.46	1,056
Right Fast	28.5	66.9	17.2%	2.35	810
Off Spin	26.7	69.2	10.6%	2.59	656
Left Fast	30.2	77.0	27.3%	2.55	196
Leg Break	39.5	85.9	14.4%	2.17	184
Left Orthodox	45.0	100.0	14.4%	2.22	180
Right Medium	19.5	83.0	20.9%	4.26	141

Start of Innings vs Set

Starts securely — their dismissal rate barely drops once set (2.5 early vs 2.8/100); early pressure alone won't buy their wicket. Early runs come mainly off the drive (38%).

Phase	Average	Strike rate	False-shot %	Dismissals / 100	Boundary %	Balls
First 30 balls	26.0	66	19%	2.53	8%	1,346
Once set (31+)	30.6	86	13%	2.81	9%	926

How Attacks Bowl To Them (last 3 series)

v Bangladesh · 1 Test · 100 balls · 60 runs · avg 60.0

Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v Afghanistan · 1 Test · 8 balls · 5 runs · avg 5.0

Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

v New Zealand · 2 Tests · 228 balls · 85 runs · avg 21.2

Too few balls in this series to compare a plan.

Only the balls of each attack's pace plan that differed from what the same bowlers gave that side's other LHB top-order batters. The full dismissal detail sits in the vision playlists.

Our Best Options (simulated matchups)

From the match simulation — a tool that plays each batter-v-bowler pairing out thousands of times from their full Test profiles. Low expected average = the bowler wins the matchup. "Cohort" confidence = they have not faced enough of that type for a personal read.

Bowler	Type	Exp avg	Exp SR	Out in first 30 %	Stock wicket ball	Top dismissal	Confidence
Xavier Bartlett	Right pace	21.2	72.7	57.1	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 26.9%	High
Josh Hazlewood	Right pace	26.6	71.6	49.2	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.6%	Med
Nathan Ellis	Right pace	30.9	80.1	48.1	short, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.8%	High
Adam Zampa	Leg-spin	32.3	91.6	55.8	good length, outside off	LBW 21.5%	Cohort
Mitch Marsh	Right pace	33.9	86.4	48.5	good length, 4th-stump channel	Caught behind 27.1%	Med

Structurally, off-spin turning the ball away from the LHB is the matchup class that persists — favour that angle when the individual reads are thin.

Where They're Vulnerable (vs pace)

Per bucket: batting average, strike rate, false-shot %, dismissals per 100 balls, boundary %. Pink row = their lowest-average (softest) bucket in that dimension.

Seam movement

Seam movement	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
no seam	62.5	89	9%	1.43	13%	140
seams away	41.0	57	20%	1.39	8%	72

Swing

Swing	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
no swing	—	78	10%	0.00	11%	89
swings away	28.7	69	16%	2.42	10%	124

Length

Length	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Full	28.5	93	19%	3.28	16%	122
Good length	19.5	56	17%	2.85	5%	526
Back of a length	—	132	10%	0.00	20%	60

Pitching line

Pitching line	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
outside off	26.3	82	14%	3.12	11%	96
in the channel	20.0	50	8%	2.50	5%	40
on the stumps	22.8	67	22%	2.96	9%	845
down the leg side	37.0	72	18%	1.95	9%	205

Speed

Speed	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
<125	—	96	2%	0.00	13%	52
125–133	33.5	89	16%	2.67	13%	75
133–140	56.0	72	10%	1.28	12%	78
140+	20.0	40	22%	2.00	4%	50

Over vs round

Over vs round	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Over the wicket	26.1	70	20%	2.68	9%	1,007
Round the wicket	22.3	67	19%	2.99	8%	201

DANGER BALL — WHERE THEY'RE MOST LIKELY OUT

Full / down the leg side

4.0 dismissals per 100 · averages 18 here · 50 balls · false shot 23%

How They Score & Get Out

Scores most of their runs through straight down the ground (39%; off 31% · leg 30% · straight 39%).

Shot types (risk) ▶ their pull/hook

Shot	Avg	SR	False%	Outs/100	Bdry%	Balls
Pull/Hook	17.2	153	31%	8.89	27%	45
Drive	29.2	102	28%	3.50	16%	257
Cut	36.5	170	16%	4.65	28%	43
Work/Nudge	56.4	77	14%	1.37	6%	364

Scoring mix vs the typical Test batter (all bowling)

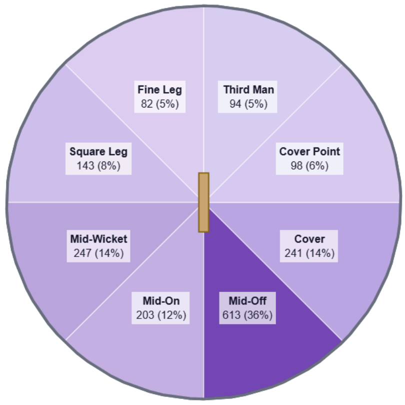
The **sweep** brings them 11% of their runs — 1.5× the typical Test batter's share. Scores unusually little off the **pull/hook** (4% of runs vs 14% typically).

Shot	% of their runs	Typical	Index	Pctl
Work/Nudge	36%	27%	1.3×	P90
Drive	35%	33%	1.1×	P62
Sweep	11%	7%	1.5×	P79
Slog	7%	5%	1.4×	P71
Cut	7%	8%	0.8×	P32
Pull/Hook	4%	14%	0.3× ▼	P1
Ramp/Scoop	0%	1%	0.0×	P14

Share of stroke-coded runs all bowling; index = their share ÷ cohort median (114 Test batters). Highlight = signature shot; ▼ = scores unusually little there.

Most often out **caught behind** (32% of dismissals); most often to right fast (19). ▶ watch dismissals

Dismissal mode	Count	%
Caught behind	19	32%
Bowled	16	27%
Caught in the field	13	22%
LBW	6	10%
Caught	5	8%
Run Out	1	2%



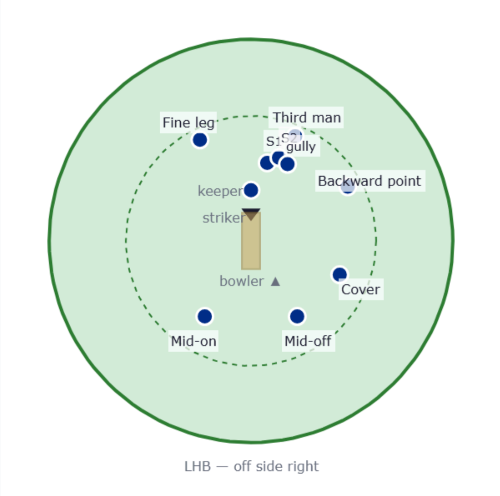
Where they score — runs by area (mirrored for a left-hander).

Suggested Fields (the stock field ± their evidenced deviations)

*Each field starts from the **stock template** for that bowler type & phase (orthodox because it works), then makes at most **three** changes — each one earned by a trigger in **their** game clearing the cohort P75 bar (do they lap, cut, pull, score square, edge early?). **Change** rows are highlighted with their stat; **Stock** rows carry the orthodoxy line. The read line backtests the changes against the pure stock field. Early = first 30 balls; Set = once in. Drawn from behind the bowler (bowler bottom, striker top); off side is on the right.*

Field vs right-arm pace

Early — first 30 balls · 654 balls

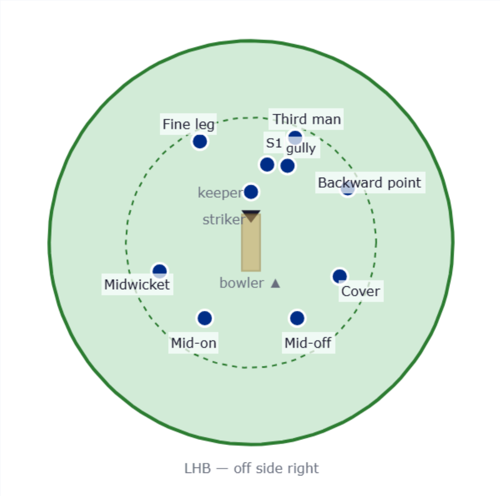


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
2nd slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure stock field. Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that *is* the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 3% of their runs where mid-off stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Once set · 297 balls

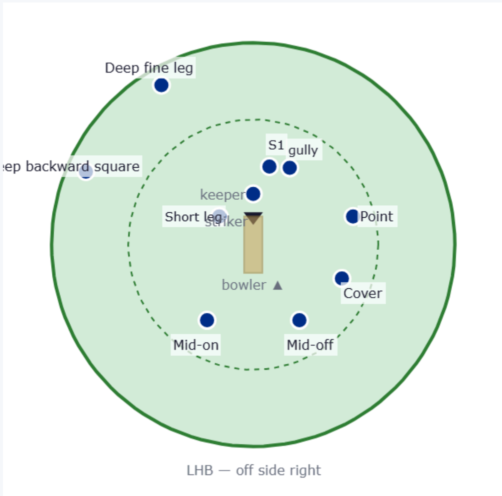


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Gully	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Third man	Stock	Standard stock position.

Pure stock field. Nothing in their game clears the deviation bar (cohort P75) against right-arm pace, so the orthodox field stands — that *is* the read.

Floating fielder: They score only 2% of their runs where mid-off stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.

Bouncer plan

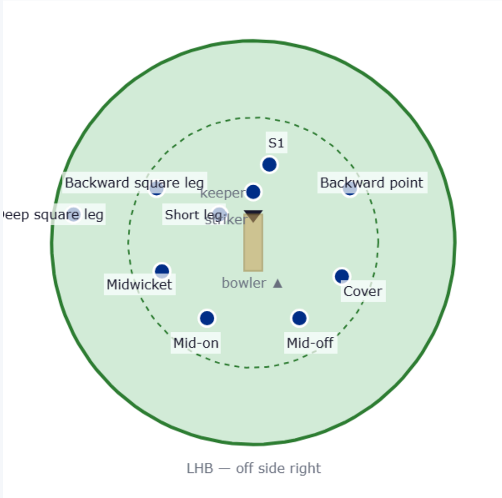


Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Change	One slip kept for the top / outside edge.
Short leg	Change	Catcher in front of square for the fend or glove off the hip.
Gully	Change	The steer or fend that flies squarer of the wicket.
Point	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Cover	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-off	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Mid-on	Change	Ring saver for the bumper plan.
Deep backward square	Change	Deep behind square for the top-edged pull.
Deep fine leg	Change	Deep behind square for the hook.

A standard bumper field — he isn't a heavy puller (P7), so this is a holding / surprise option, not a wicket-taking plan. One slip, a catcher in front of square, and the two legal leg-side riders (deep backward square + deep fine leg).

Field vs off spin

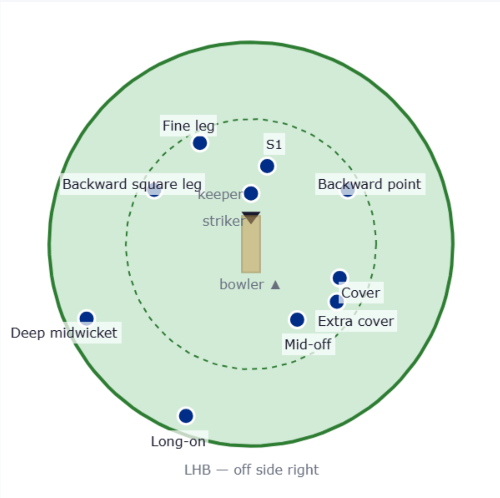
Early — first 30 balls · 320 balls



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward square leg	Change	He works 38% of his runs to leg (P88) — squarer leg-side saver.
Short leg	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep square leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted).

Once set · 336 balls



Fielder	Stock/Change	Why they're there
1st slip	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward point	Stock	Standard stock position.
Cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Extra cover	Stock	Standard stock position.
Mid-off	Stock	Standard stock position.
Long-on	Stock	Standard stock position.
Deep midwicket	Stock	Standard stock position.
Backward square leg	Change	He works 38% of his runs to leg (P88) — squarer leg-side saver.
Fine leg	Stock	Standard stock position.

Stock field + 1 change (highlighted).

Floating fielder: They score only 4% of their runs where backward square leg stands — the spare run-saver to move as the game asks.